

Gautam Velpula

VP, Software Engineering

AI & Data Platform Engineering • GenAI & Agentic AI • Cloud Modernization • Real-Time Decisioning

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Executive Summary

Engineering and architecture leader with 18+ years of experience building, modernizing, and operating mission-critical, high-volume platforms across financial services, payments, retail, and consumer technology. Proven track record leading large engineering organizations, modernizing legacy systems, and architecting cloud-native, event-driven platforms that support real-time AI inferencing, decisioning, and high-throughput transactions. Combines deep technical leadership, hands-on architectural depth, and executive partnership to drive engineering excellence, raise the performance bar, and build high-trust, high-functioning teams.

Core Competencies

Software Engineering Leadership • Enterprise Architecture • Cloud Platforms (GCP, AWS, Azure) • GenAI & Agentic AI • Real-Time Processing & Decisioning • Microservices & Event-Driven Architecture • API Strategy • PCI / Compliance & Security • Legacy Modernization • Platform Engineering • DevSecOps & Continuous Delivery • SAFe Agile & Scrum • High-Volume Transaction Platforms • Mentorship & Engineering Culture • Cross-Functional Consensus Building

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Lead engineering and architecture strategy for a multi-brand enterprise spanning digital, payments, marketing technology, and data platforms, partnering with executive leadership to align technology investments with business outcomes.
- Established and lead a senior engineering and architecture community of principal and lead architects, sponsoring guilds and working sessions, fostering cross-team collaboration, and building high-trust, high-performance teams across the technology organization.
- Modernized legacy backend systems to a cloud-native, microservices, event-driven architecture, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns to support high-throughput, resilient, and observable services.
- Lead the **GoTo Foods AI Working Group**, the enterprise governing body that reviews and approves all AI-based initiatives company-wide, ensuring strategic alignment, technical viability, and adherence to security, compliance, and AI governance standards.
- Architecting a **real-time Agentic AI solution** that integrates real-time processing, decisioning, and orchestration across digital platforms and internal systems, leveraging **AWS Bedrock** and frontier models from **Anthropic (Claude)**, **OpenAI**, **Google**, and **AWS**, with patterns, guardrails, and governance for safe and scalable enterprise use.
- Drive enterprise adoption of **GenAI and LLM-enabled development practices**, including rollout of **GitHub Copilot** and **Claude** for engineering productivity, and embedding AI capabilities into APIs, event-driven services, and internal tooling in partnership with engineering, data, and product teams.

- Designed and delivered enterprise payments integration with **FreedomPay** across all brands; key participant in the annual **PCI DSS audit**, sustaining compliance across high-volume payment and transaction systems.
- Consolidated 7 independent brand apps and websites onto a unified digital platform, retiring redundant systems, materially reducing development and operating cost, and improving developer experience; architected a subscription platform to support new business models.
- Governed Martech and Customer Data Platform integrations, aligning third-party platforms with a centralized customer data model to enable accurate analytics, attribution, and personalization.
- Partner with security and compliance to establish DevSecOps standards, secure-by-design patterns, and AI governance, balancing agility with risk and regulatory requirements.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30% through architectural standardization, platform consolidation, and continuous delivery.
- Mentor architects, engineers, product owners, and business stakeholders to instill engineering craftsmanship, raise the technical bar, and build a strong technical leadership pipeline.

Slalom Consulting

2018 – 2021

Senior Delivery Principal

- Senior engineering and advisory lead for multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and payments engagements with Fortune 500 clients, including financial services and large-scale eCommerce organizations.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise architecture assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture, modernization roadmap, and reusable platform capabilities.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to **GCP** for a leading point-of-sale provider, modernizing infrastructure, data, and application tiers.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization, addressing **PCI compliance**, resilience, and high-volume, low-latency transaction processing.
- Served as primary executive-facing technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable engineering and architecture roadmaps, business cases, and TCO models.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models across engineering, architecture, product, and design teams, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and consistent repeat business.
- Mentored delivery principals, engineers, and architects, strengthening leadership depth, architectural thinking, and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)

2014 – 2018

Director, Professional Services

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations and integrations for Fortune 500 clients with end-to-end accountability across pre-sales, solution architecture, delivery, and post-implementation optimization.
- Served as senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance, escalation support, and technology evangelism for emerging capabilities.
- Advised C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business outcomes, driving organizational change, and managing executive relationships.
- Supported sales through POCs, demos, and solution design, and partnered with product management to influence product roadmap based on enterprise client needs.
- Built and scaled a global professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology & Methodology

Cloud & Platform: Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS, Microsoft Azure (AKS, API Management, Functions, Front Door, Blob Storage), Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture & Integration: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST / GraphQL APIs, API Gateways, SOA, SaaS / IaaS / PaaS

AI Platforms & Tools: AWS Bedrock, Claude (Anthropic), GitHub Copilot; frontier models from Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, and AWS

AI Patterns & Practices: GenAI, Agentic AI, real-time inferencing & decisioning, LLM application patterns, AI governance & guardrails

Data, Streaming & Messaging: Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Compliance & Security: PCI DSS (annual audit participant), DevSecOps, Secure-by-Design, Risk & Regulatory

Analytics & Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Payments, Martech & Integrations: FreedomPay, Amperity CDP, Olo, Punchh, Yext, Qu POS

Methodologies & Frameworks: SAFe Agile, Scrum, DevSecOps, Platform Engineering, Continuous Delivery, Engineering Excellence

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India